

Getting used to other babies

Your baby is fascinated by other babies and toddlers, even though at this age they will engage in parallel play rather than interact and share toys. Let him play alongside another baby or a slightly older sibling or cousin—this will help him become more social and he may gravitate toward other babies at a playgroup.



Building familiarity

You are probably out and about visiting friends and relatives now that your baby is older and more socially aware. Before you leave home, show him photos of the relatives or friends you will be visiting and repeat their names to him several times. When you are together, check that he's not overwhelmed by new people by regularly removing him for some short one-on-one time with you. Pack a comfort blanket or favorite toy in case he needs more than a hug for reassurance.

